

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Monday, 29 June 2026 · 13:31 IST
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Bottom line: Big-tech platforms ServiceNow and Salesforce are aggressively expanding their agentic AI footprint through strategic partnerships, governance focus, and market penetration efforts, while CCaaS incumbent Five9 attempts to differentiate its AI strategy with a "human touch" narrative amidst ongoing business model pressures. Kore.ai must continue to highlight its superior platform reliability, predictable TCO, and deep CX-native analyst validation against these broad-based plays.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

ServiceNow Doubles Down on AI Governance and Ecosystem Expansion

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-06-28) ServiceNow is facing a key milestone on July 29 for its AI Governance initiatives, signaling a push for robust control over its AI offerings. Concurrently, (2026-06-26) ServiceNow has united with Google Cloud to scale AI agents for autonomous enterprise operations and (2026-06-26) partnered with HCLTech to further scale enterprise AI with Google Cloud, expanding its ecosystem. [Ad-hoc-news.de](#) / [HPCwire](#) / [CXO Digitalpulse](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
ServiceNow's focus on governance and broad partnerships signals a strategic move to build trust and expand its platform's reach beyond ITSM. Kore.ai can undercut by highlighting ServiceNow's "assists" consumption unpredictability and ITSM-centric lock-in, contrasting it with Kore.ai's ABL-driven compile-time validation, deterministic execution, and predictable cost attribution for external CX, alongside its true omnichannel capabilities.

Agentforce Pushes Market Penetration with POCs and SMB Focus

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-06-27) Salesforce is promoting one-day Agentforce Operations POCs to accelerate adoption and (2026-06-26) expanding Agentforce into Salesforce Suites and Slack CRM for small businesses in the Philippines, indicating a push for broader market penetration and ease of entry. [Salesforce](#) / [Salesforce](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
Salesforce's focus on rapid POCs and SMB expansion aims to lower adoption barriers. Kore.ai can leverage Agentforce's known pricing unpredictability ("credit anxiety") and Data Cloud/platform lock-in. We should emphasize Kore.ai's transparent, per-agent/intent/tool cost attribution, model-agnostic tiering, and comprehensive enterprise-grade platform depth that goes beyond CRM-centric automation.

Five9 Positions AI with "Human Touch" Amidst Strategy Review

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-06-26) A Five9 study highlights the "Human Touch Key to AI Trust," suggesting a positioning strategy that balances AI automation with human interaction. This comes as (2026-06-26) Five9 provides an earnings outlook and details its AI strategy, with shares being tracked on NASDAQ. [MarTech Cube](#) / [Ad-hoc-news.de](#)

WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI

Five9's "human touch" narrative could be a defensive play against full automation or an attempt to differentiate its AI. Kore.ai can highlight Five9's structural exposure of its seat-based model to AI deflection (as flagged by analysts) and its enterprise WFM scalability gaps. Kore.ai offers a superior cost-per-resolution model and robust agent-assist capabilities that genuinely enhance human agents, all built on a platform with proven enterprise scalability and analyst leadership.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
ServiceNow Agent Platform	(2026-06-26) Partnered with Google Cloud and HCLTech for enterprise AI scaling. HPCwire	High	ITSM lock-in, assist credits, no native voice vs. ABL determinism, predictable TCO, omnichannel.
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-06-27) Promoting one-day Agentforce Operations POCs. Salesforce	Med	Pricing unpredictability, Data Cloud lock-in vs. clear cost attribution, model-agnostic platform.
Five9	(2026-06-26) Study finds human touch key to AI trust; earnings outlook. MarTech Cube	Low	Seat-based model exposure, WFM scalability gap vs. cost-per-outcome, enterprise scale.
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-06-28) Wimbledon enlists IBM for AI-powered fan experiences. MediaPost	Low	Back-office focus, Gartner Challenger vs. CX Leader, omnichannel.
Cresta	(2026-06-26) CEO discusses AI partnership with the New York Mets. CNBC	Low	Conversation data moat as design input vs. production reliability, full-lifecycle platform.

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- ServiceNow's AI Governance milestone on July 29 for potential new announcements or positioning.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Arm sales teams with battlecards highlighting ServiceNow's "assists" consumption unpredictability and ITSM-centric lock-in, contrasting it with Kore.ai's ABL-driven determinism and predictable TCO for external CX.
- Develop product marketing messaging that emphasizes Kore.ai's transparent, per-interaction cost attribution and model-agnostic platform as a clear alternative to Agentforce's complex pricing and platform lock-in.

- Reinforce Kore.ai's analyst leadership in *Conversational AI for Customer Service* to differentiate from big-tech platforms that lead in adjacent (ITSM/CRM) categories but lack deep CX-specific validation.
- Proactively engage with prospects evaluating Five9, showcasing Kore.ai's superior cost-per-resolution model and enterprise-grade scalability as a direct answer to Five9's business model challenges.